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SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. LLL-A-00650a(GSA-FSS)
May 12, 1959 and
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June 5, 1950

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ARCH AND CLIP BOARD FILES, WOOD OR COMPOSITION HARDBOARD BACK

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers arch and clip board files for holding papers (sheets, etc.) in general office use.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and sizes.* — Arch and clip board files, wood or composition hardboard back, covered by this specification shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.1). A plus or minus tolerance of ⅛ inch will be permitted in the overall length and width of the boards.

Type I.—Arch board with or without paper perforator, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.1).

Sizes (inches):

7 by 12
9 by 14½
9 by 17

Type II.—Clip board.

Sizes (inches):

9 by 12½
9 by 15½
9¼ by 11¾
9 by 17
13¼ by 11¼

1.2.2 *Classes.*—The board files shall be of the following classes, as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.1):

Class A.—Wood back.
Class B.—Composition hardboard back.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-121—Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
UU-P-701—Pressboard; Colored.
LLL-H-35—Hardboard, Fibrous-Felted (Fiberboard).
PPP-B-585—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

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PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiber.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-10377—Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.

MIL-L-10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. — The material shall be as specified hereinafter and shall be of such quality that the structural strength of the component parts of the board files will not be impaired.

3.1.1 *Wood.* — All wood used in the construction of board files shall be hardwood. Knots in the wood less than one-third the width of strips used in the boards will be permitted provided they do not interfere with the glue lines in the board.

3.1.2 *Composition hardboard.* — All composition hardboard used in the construction of board files shall conform to the requirements of Federal Specification LLL-H-35.

3.1.3 *Metal.*—All metal used in the construction of the board files shall be a good commercial quality commonly used for the purpose intended (see 3.5).

3.2 Backs.—The backs shall be either class A, wood or class B, composition hardboard. All corners and edges shall be rounded.

3.2.1 *Class A, wood.*—The class A back shall be made from alternate strips of wood of contrasting color, 1 to $1\frac{3}{16}$ inches, inclusive, in width and $\frac{1}{4} \pm \frac{1}{32}$ inch thick, matched and joined to form a smooth-faced board (see 3.1.1 and 3.5).

3.2.2 *Class B, composition hardboard.*—The class B back shall be made from $\frac{1}{8} \pm \frac{1}{32}$-inch-thick smooth-faced composition hardboard (see 3.1.2 and 3.5).

3.3 Type I, arch board.—The type I board file shall have either a class A or class B back on which shall be securely mounted at the top an arch-type paper holder and at the bottom, when required, a paper perforator (see 3.3.2). When specified, an alphabetical index with a cover and metal compressor shall also be furnished (see 3.3.3).

3.3.1 *Arch paper holder.*—The arch paper holder shall have a metal base with two metal arches spaced on $2\frac{3}{4}$-inch centers. Each arch

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shall have a fixed and a movable portion spaced on 2¾-inch centers. The arches shall be firmly attached to the board so that under ordinary usage, the mechanism will not become detached.

3.3.1.1 The base shall have superimposed thereon the movable and fixed portions of the arches. A concealed-spring locking device within the base, or a single-action lever-type locking device, shall firmly hold the movable portion of each arch when in either an open or closed position. The arch shall open and close easily and be in alignment when closed. The base shall have as an integral part, an eye or cut-out approximately ⅜ inch in diameter and extending beyond the upper edge of the board a sufficient distance to permit hanging the board against a flat surface.

3.3.1.2 The movable portion of each arch shall be a J-shaped wire approximately ⅛ inch in diameter. On the concealed-spring locking device type, the longer arm of the wire shall pass through a hole in the upper part of the base to engage with the locking device; the shorter arm shall connect with the fixed portion of the arch when the arch sections are closed.

3.3.1.3 The fixed portion of each arch shall be metal and shall be of either solid or hollow construction. Hollow construction shall consist of two upright hollow posts, approximately ⅛ inch in internal diameter, with tops cut back to receive the ends of movable J-shaped wires. Solid construction shall consist of two upright solid posts, approximately ⅛ inch in diameter, with tops designed to provide a suitable stop for the movable J-shaped wires when the arch is closed. The fixed portion of the arch shall have a usable filing height of 2½ inches plus or minus ¼ inch.

3.3.2 *Perforator.* — When specified (see 6.1), arch boards shall be equipped with a metal perforator with an overall height not greater than 1¼ inches above the face of the board. The perforator mechanism shall punch two ¼-inch holes 2¾ inches center-to-center; punches shall not stick in the dies and perforations shall be free from torn or ragged edges and entirely punched out. A tolerance of plus $\frac{1}{32}$ inch will be permitted in size of hole after punching. The perforator shall perform satisfactorily when tested in accordance with 4.3.

3.3.3 *Indexes and covers.* — When furnished, indexes and covers shall be perforated so as to pass readily over any portion of the arch sections and shall comply with the following requirements:

3.3.3.1 *Indexes.*—The indexes shall consist of at least 20 manila cards of graduated lengths, lettered, and arranged so as to form an alphabetical index along the right-hand margin of the file.

3.3.3.2 *Covers.* — The covers shall be of 0.030-inch pressboard conforming to the requirements for type I of Federal Specification UU-P-701. Unless otherwise specified, the covers for boards shall be not more than the width of board specified and not less than ½ inch below the size of width specified. Covers shall be not less than 11 inches in length for size 9- by 14½-inch boards and not less than 13 inches in length for size 9- by 17-inch boards. Unless otherwise specified, lengths of covers for other length boards shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice. Each cover shall be equipped with a suitable metal compressor so designed that it will hold the cover at any point on the fixed portion of the arch.

3.4 Type II, clip board.—The type II board file shall have either a class A or class B back to which a metal spring clip for holding paper sheets shall be firmly attached at the upper end by eyelets or rivets; the spring shall be firmly held in place by a rivet. The jaws of the clip shall be at least 5½ inches in width, shall open at least 1 inch, and shall be capable of holding securely any number of sheets of paper from one sheet to full capacity of the jaws. The upper part of the clip shall be furnished with an eye or cutout ⅜ ± ⅛ inch

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in diameter, concavely shaped to allow the thumb of the operator to rest firmly over the eye. The upper part of the clip metal shall not flex when pressure is exerted to open the clip. The edge of the eye shall be such that it will not cut. The lower or base portion of the clip shall have as an integral part, an eye or cutout at least 3/8 inch in diameter, extending beyond the edge of the upper end of the board a sufficient distance to permit hanging the board against a flat surface.

3.5 **Finish.**—All exposed metal parts shall be treated to resist corrosion and shall meet the test requirements specified in 4.3.1. Wood parts shall have a lacquer or varnish finish in accordance with good commercial practice. Composition hardboard shall have a smooth-one-side surface finish (see 3.2.2).

3.6 **Identification marking of product.**—Unless otherwise specified, marking of file boards shall be in accordance with standard commercial practice.

3.7 **Workmanship.**—The boards shall be free from knots, blemishes, and other defects which affect the appearance or which might affect the serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **General.**—The procedures outlined below are to be followed in sampling, inspecting, and testing material described above when it is purchased by the Government.

4.1.1 *Examination and testing responsibility.*—Unless otherwise specified, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission of material for Government inspection. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or other laboratories acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and made available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2 **Sampling and inspection.** — Sampling and inspection shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105, as hereinafter specified.

4.2.1 *Sampling and examination of preparation for delivery.*—The sample of shipping containers from each shipment shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105. Each sample container shall be examined for conformance to the detail requirements of the contract or order for defects of construction and marking, such as wrong style and improper materials or construction; improper application of staples; broken or torn score lines; holes in container walls; inadequate closure (flaps do not meet, glued flaps may be lifted without fiber failure over 75 percent of glue area, or sealing tape is nonadherent); straps missing or wrong gage; marking missing, incorrect or illegible; and unit packaging or marking incorrect. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4 percent defective.

4.2.2 *Sampling for visual inspection.* — From the shipping containers taken for inspection in accordance with 4.2.1, select arch or clip board files for inspection. Approximately an equal number shall be taken from each sample container. The AQL for major defects shall be 1.5 percent defective and for minor defects 4 percent defective.

4.2.3 *Sampling for tests.*—One or more representative sample board files of each type and class shall be taken from the lot and subjected to and pass the tests specified in 4.3.

4.3 **Tests.**—Samples shall be tested and measured to determine compliance with the requirements of this specification. The movable section of the arch on type I files shall be operated 25 times to determine whether the arch retains its position firmly in both the open and closed positions. The perforator on type I board files shall be tested by perforating type I, 32-pound, white bond paper, conforming to Federal Specification UU-P-121. Six sheets of the bond paper shall be perf-

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TABLE I.

Defects	Major	Minor
a. Material:		
Boards not hardwood or composition hardboard, as specified	x	
Hardwood strips not free of knots less than one-third the width of strips	x	
Knots interfere with glue line	x	
Hardwood strips not width or thickness specified within tolerances	x	
Composition hardboard not thickness specified within tolerance	x	
b. Finish—backs:		
Boards not smooth	x	
Hardwood board not finished as specified	x	
Composition hardboard not finished as specified	x	
Boards warped, cracked	x	
Light scratches or grooves		x
Varnish or lacquer runs, orange peel		x
Composition hardboard contains blisters	x	
Corners and edges not rounded	x	
c. Dimensions—overall:		
Sizes—not width or length required within tolerances specified	x	
Not thickness specified within tolerance		x
d. Arch paper holder:		
Not centered on board		x
Not firmly fastened to board	x	
Arches not spaced on 2¾-inch centers	x	
Locking device absent	x	
Locking device does not hold arches firmly in opened or closed position	x	
Movable J-wires and fixed posts do not align when arch closed (open and close each arch seven times)	x	
Movable J-wires do not connect fixed posts when arch is closed	x	
Arch J-wires not proper diameter		x
Solid posts not cut back to suitably stop movable J-wires	x	
Hollow posts do not have internal diameter approximately ⅛ inch, or not cut back to receive J-wires	x	
Fixed post length below cut back not 2½ inches within tolerance	x	
Eye or cutout missing or does not clear upper edge of board to allow hanging on flat wall	x	
e. Perforator (if required by order):		
Perforator missing	x	
Overall height more than 1¼ inches		x
Holes punched are greater than ¼-inch diameter (plus 1/32 inch)		x
Holes punched not 2¾ inches center-to-center	x	
f. Indexes and covers (when specified):		
Do not pass readily over arch section		x
Not required composition or construction	x	
g. Clipboard:		
Clip metal flexures	x	
Clip not firmly attached to back	x	
Jaw width not 5½ inches or more	x	
Jaw opens to less than 1 inch	x	
Clip spring not firmly held in place by eyelet or rivet	x	
Clip will not hold paper pack securely at full capacity (open and close each clip seven times, fill to capacity—paper shall be securely held)	x	
Clip upper part not concave for thumb pressure	x	
Clip upper part concavity not furnished with ⅜- ± ⅛-inch eye	x	
Clip eye or any part sharp or jagged	x	
Clip lower part does not have extension or cut out with minimum ⅜-inch hole extending beyond upper end of board so board may be hung against flat wall	x	
Rivets holding clip to board not peened and smooth		x

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orated, one at a time, and then these sheets shall be assembled as one unit and perforated at different locations at least three times. The locking device on type II files shall be operated 25 times by hand pressure to ascertain the proper operation of the spring clip and single-action lever-type mechanism.

4.3.1 *Corrosion test.*—All metal parts included in the samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested for corrosion by placing them in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of 15 minutes. The metal parts, upon being removed from this solution, shall be immediately immersed in a 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature. They shall then be removed from this solution and, without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature. The metal parts shall then be rinsed in luke-warm water and allowed to dry.

4.3.2 *Composition hardboard (class B).*—The composition hardboard shall be tested for compliance with the requirements of Federal Specification LLL-H-35.

4.4 **Rejection.**—Failure to meet the requirements of 4.2 and 4.3 shall be cause for rejection.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 **Federal Standard No. 102 (for civil agencies only).**—The definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

5.2 **Packaging (see 6.1).**

5.2.1 *Levels A, B, or C.*—Unless otherwise specified, arch and clip boards shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's normal practice.

5.3 **Packing (see 6.1).**

5.3.1 *Level A.*—Arch and clip boards of one type, class, and size only, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed in the most compact manner in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container constructed, closed and strapped to conform to class 2, V3c or V3s, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP-B-636. Alternatively, shipping containers may be used that are constructed and strapped to conform to overseas type of Federal Specification PPP-B-591, PPP-B-601, or Military Specification MIL-B-10377; class 2, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP-B-621; or style 1, 2 or 2A, class 3 use of Federal Specification PPP-B-585. Each shipping container shall be provided with a type I or II, grade B or C, class 2 sealed case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL-L-10547. Gross weight of wood-type boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds; fiberboard boxes shall not exceed the weight limitation of the box specification.

5.3.2 *Level B.*—Arch and clip boards of one type, class, and size only, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.3.1, except that case liners shall not be required and shipping containers shall be constructed to conform to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP-B-636. Alternatively, shipping containers may be used that are constructed to conform to domestic type, style A or B of Federal Specification PPP-B-591, PPP-B-601, or Military Specification MIL-B-10377; class 1, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP-B-621; or style 1, 2 or 2A, class 1 use of Federal Specification PPP-B-585.

5.3.3 *Level C.*—Unless otherwise specified, arch and clip boards, packaged as specified in 5.2.1, shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose so constructed as to comply with the carrier rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation at the lowest rate to point of delivery.

5.4 **Marking.**

5.4.1 *Civil agencies.*—In addition to any special marking required in the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123,

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including classification of item (type, class, size, etc.).

5.4.2 *Military agencies.* — Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with requirements of Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.**—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and should specify type, class, size, and level of packaging and packing required, including any special marking for shipment desired. If paper perforators and indexes and covers are required with type I boards, it should be so specified. (See 1.2.1, 1.2.2, 3.3, 3.3.2, 4.1.1, 5.2, 5.3 and 5.4.)

6.2 **Transportation description.** — The transportation description applicable to these items is:

Board, clip, wooden, with fixtures, with or without accompanying accessories.

Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds.

6.3 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—QM
Navy—S
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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